

“My5” Projects

When you register on Tuesday, your assigned schedule of projects to interview will be based upon the best possible matching known between your expertise and all projects in your category. However, what the assignment algorithm can know in advance of project judging is inherently limited, so once you view the *actual* project displays, you may discover some projects not in your initial assigned set for which you would also be interested in interviewing and scoring. To account for this situation, ISEF will provide an opportunity for you to specify up to five of those projects and assist you subsequently to interview them. We call this set of projects that you specify, “My5” projects.

Which Projects Should I Select?

The reasons that you might want to include a project in your “My5” set are manifold. Most commonly, you will select a project because you are an expert in the field of that project. Alternatively, on your tour of the display floor on Tuesday afternoon or evening, claims on some project displays will attract your attention so you would like to learn more from the students themselves. Finally, you may have learned of an interesting project during Tuesday dinner while talking with your fellow judges in your category caucus room. Anything stimulating your interest is a sensible reason to include a particular project as one of your “My5” projects.

Purposes of “My5” Projects

The benefit to you in including a project among your “My5” projects is that doing so will increase the likelihood that you will have the opportunity to interview it. This happens through two mechanisms: the final set of two interviews assigned during periods 19-20, and your option to score up to two additional unscheduled interviews.

Periods 19-20

The algorithm which assigns interviews in periods 19-20 will, to the maximum extent possible, assign you to your “My5” projects. This does not *guarantee* that you will be assigned your preferred projects because other judges may select them as well, and only two judges can be scheduled to interview a given project in the final two periods. However, in the past, the most common reason that judges were *not* assigned to their “My5” projects is that they neglected to select any projects. Those judges who select a full set of five such projects more often than not have interviews assigned from that set.

Unscheduled Interviews

The one way to be sure to interview a project in which you are interested is to be proactive and interview it during one of your five “free” periods among the first 18. Late Tuesday night each project will have its own interview schedule placed on its display table so that Wednesday morning before Period 1 or during your first break you can go around to each of your “My5” projects and see when they are scheduled. Plan to use a period when you are both free. If they are busy when you arrive, check the project’s schedules again to see when its free periods next match up with yours.

Note: You cannot reserve an interview period with a given project by writing in your name on the project's schedule. Only scheduled interviews that are pre-printed are recognized in giving priority to any judge. See document *I: Interview Conflicts with Other Judges* in section III of the Judge Information Board for more information.

How to Select (and Unselect) Your "My5" Projects

Elsewhere on the Judge Information Board (document *F: How to Enter Scores* in Section III) you have been given instructions on how to access and login to the secure web site through which all judging records will be entered. Here, we are solely concerned with the process of identifying "My5" projects to the scoring system.

Within this scoring web site, you will find a list of projects in your category similar to the figure shown on the left below. In order to select a given project you simply click (or tap) on the star corresponding to your desired project, which results in something like that on the right below. Consequently, we will colloquially refer to the process of selecting a project as "starring" it.

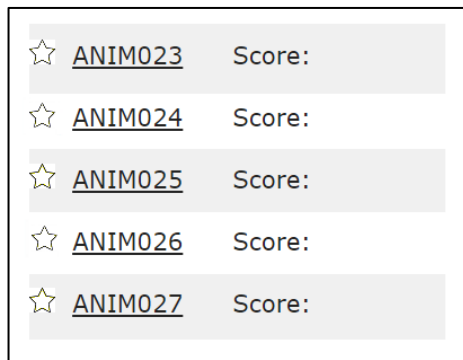


Figure 1 Unstarred projects

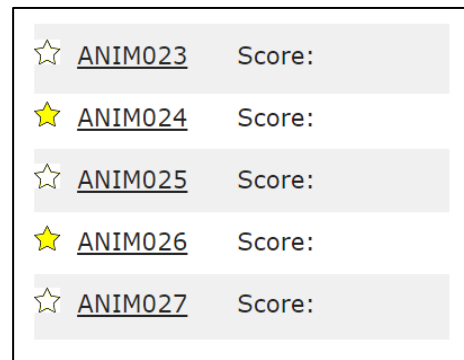


Figure 2 Starred projects

Later, if you want to change your decision, simply click (or tap) on a selected star and it will toggle off. You will be able to toggle stars on and off only until the beginning of Interview Period 1.

Limits on "My5" Projects

Project Limitation

As mentioned above, you cannot select a project in your initial set of assigned interviews.

Number Limitation

You can select no more than five projects. If after having selected five projects you discover a new project of more interest to you, you will need to make room by "unstarring" one of your currently selected projects before you can "star" the new discovery.

Time Limitation

You can begin adding projects to your “My5” set as soon as you register on Tuesday and receive your initial interview schedule.¹ This facility will remain active until the beginning of Interview Period 1 on Wednesday. After that, your “My5” projects are fixed.

Unscheduled Interviews

When you do an unscheduled interview of one of your “My5” projects, you do not need to worry about “unstarring” it. (Besides, you cannot change “My5” projects at that point.) The star will have served its function of bringing the project to your attention.

Important: As long as you record scores for an unscheduled interview in a timely manner, that project will not be assigned to you during the final two periods. The assignments for those two periods will be generated immediately after the lunch break (during Interview Period 10) so be aware that if you delay entering your scores until then, the system will not know about your unscheduled interview and you *may* be assigned to the same project again.

Historical Note

Through 2019, “My5 Projects” were named “Starred Projects” because the process of selecting a project of interest involves clicking the “star” icon. However, this name caused problems for some judges who thought that the projects that they “starred” had to be “stars,” that is, projects that were outstanding in some way. The name has now been changed to represent the meaning more accurately: five projects of interest to each judge.

Points of Emphasis

1. “My5” projects are projects of interest to you, and not assigned to you during the first 18 interview periods.
2. You can select up to five “My5” projects, but only between the time you register on Tuesday and the start of Interview Period #1 on Wednesday.
3. For the final two interview periods you will be assigned to your “My5” projects to the maximum extent possible. Before then, you can also use two of your five unscheduled periods to interview and score projects you have starred.

¹ Because you cannot star a project on your assigned schedule, you also cannot star projects before you get that schedule. Your assigned projects cannot be known before you register because the assignments at Registration depend upon all assignments that have been made before you register. These assignments are optimized for both judge and student experiences given the constraint of all then-extant assignments.